

October 2021

**DAVIS HAYFIELD, MAIN STREET, EAST BOXFORD
WILDFLOWER AND POLLINATOR MEADOW**

BTA BOLT proposes to encourage the growth of wildflowers at the Davis Hayfield by managing and planting a wildflower/pollinator meadow. The Davis Hayfield is owned by the Town of Boxford and is under the control of the Boxford Select Board. BTA BOLT was granted permission by the Select Board to manage the site as an open field as provided in the Conservation Restriction. BTA BOLT is the Grantee of the CR and monitors the site annually. The wildflower and pollinator meadow will be located within a 100-ft by 60-ft portion of the 4.56-acre site. Of the 4.56 acres approximately 2 acres are open field. The wildflower and pollinator meadow will be located to the east side of the field and will occupy about 15% of the existing field.

The wildflower and pollinator meadow will be created by following a mowing regimen of mowing sections on a rotating basis. This method has been found to be successful by the Sudbury Valley Trustees and the Littleton Conservation Commission, members of the Metrowest Conservation Alliance. In an earlier version of this project description rototilling along with mowing was proposed. We have eliminated the rototilling and will utilize mowing sections within the field on a rotating basis. We will oversee the area as needed with a native wildflower/pollinator mix. The following is taken from the Metrowest Conservation Alliance publication, "Field Management – Mowing Strategies to Maintain Ecologically Valuable Fields", updated July 23, 2020:

"The primary goal of managing the field... is to maintain it as a field and prevent succession into a forest. To accomplish this, mow every two to three years to keep woody vegetation at bay. Do not mow the whole field at once. Instead, divide the field into two or three segments that are rotationally mowed. The mowing schedule could be to mow the northern section in the first year, mow the southern section in the second, mow nothing in the third year, and repeat.

Mow the sections in either late fall or early spring to allow perennial plants to complete their life cycles. Mowing later in fall or spring can promote wildflowers and other forbs, which would be beneficial to pollinators and other insects. Sometimes late season wildflowers, like Canada goldenrod, can become weedy and dominate the field. To suppress these weedy wildflowers, mow between August 1st and September 15th, which is before these plants set seed. Keep mowing during this period until the weedy forbs are at a preferred abundance.

Set the mower height to at least six inches; although higher is typically better. A minimum height of six inches protects wildlife like small mammals, snakes, and nesting turtles. Do not mow outward-in. This pattern traps wildlife as the mower encircles the field toward the middle. Instead, mow either inward-out or in rows."

All work will occur in upland, outside of all wetland resource areas, including riverfront area and any associated buffer zone.

Once established the wildflower and pollinator meadow will be mowed on a rotating basis in different sections of the field as described above from the Metrowest Conservation Alliance publication. Fertilizers and pesticides will not be applied.

see attached plan